

LEARNER GUIDE

Unit Standard Title: INTERPRET AND USE INFORMATION FROM TEXTS
Unit Standard No: 119457
Unit Standard Credits: 5
NQF Level: 3

In terms of the Copyright Act 1978:

No part of this manual may be reproduced or translated in any form or by any means, electronic or mechanical including photocopying, recording or by an information storage and retrieval system without the express permission from TDA.

COPYRIGHT: TRAINING DYNAMICS AFRICA

First edition 2008

Publications disclaimer

Neither the authors nor the SETA can accept any responsibility for any legal or any other consequences, which may arise directly or indirectly as a result of the use or adaptation of or reliance upon any of the content of this material.

This material has been compiled based on the **UNIT STANDARD 119457: INTERPRET AND USE INFORMATION FROM TEXTS**

The program has been accredited by SASSETA in the Republic of South Africa.

Material compiled by:

Training Dynamics Africa

PROGRAM GUIDE	5-10
1. Introduction	5
2. Purpose of this learning program	5
3. Standards and qualifications	5
4. Assessments	6
5. Range statements	6
6. The learning guide	6
7. Learning assumed to be in place	7
8. Preparation of summative assessment	10
9. Roles and responsibilities	10
Study unit 1: Reading and/or viewing strategies	11-30
1. Introduction	13
2. Unfamiliar words and their correct meaning	13
3. Different options for the meanings of ambiguous words must be tested, and selected meanings corrected in relation to the context	19
4. Main ideas must be separated from supporting evidence, and paraphrased or summarized	20
5. The purpose of visual and/or graphic representations in texts are recognized and explained	22
6. Features of visual texts are explained in relation to the way they impact on meaning	23
Study unit 2: Use of range of strategies	31-36
1. Introduction	33
2. The source of the text must be identified in terms of reliability and possible bias	33
3. Attitudes, beliefs and intentions must be explored in order to determine the point of view expressed directly or indirectly	33
4. Techniques used in terms of purpose and audience are explored and explained	34
5. Identify and explain how selection or omission of information can promote or support a particular line of thought/cause	35
Study unit 3: Respond to selected texts	37-49
1. Introduction	39
2. Instructions and request are acted upon	39
3. Text-type, format and register used are on the appropriate level of formality	39

4.	Comprehension skills	40
5.	Guidelines to assist you in reading for meaning	40
6.	Answering techniques	41
7.	Language structures and features	42

Bibliography	47
---------------------	----

Unit standard	49-52
----------------------	--------------

1. Introduction

This learning program is part of a complete qualification. For more details concerning the complete qualification please contact your service provider or alternatively the office of the SASSETA

2. Purpose of this learning program

Learners at this level read and view a range of texts. People credited with this unit standard are able to read and view a variety of text types with understanding and to justify their views and responses by reference to detailed evidence from texts. They are also able to evaluate the effectiveness of different texts for different audiences and purposes by using a set of criteria for analysis.

Learners credited with this unit standard are able to:

- ♦ Use a range of reading and viewing strategies to understand the literal meaning of specific texts.
- ♦ Use strategies for extracting implicit messages in texts.
- ♦ Respond to selected texts in a manner appropriate to the context.
- ♦ Explore and explain how language structures and features may influence a reader/viewer.

2.1 Target group

This program is compiled for the following **target group**:

- Security members
- South African Defense Force members
- South African Police Force members
- Correctional Services
- Individuals who wishes to complete the NQF level 3 National Certificate in security practices.

3. Standards and qualifications

It is important that you as the learner understand and realize that this training program is not presented in isolation, but that it was developed based upon nationally recognized standards known as unit standards.

REMEMBER.....

Unit standards are the “building blocks” of qualifications. All qualifications are plotted on the National Qualifications Framework (NQF).

Unit standards comprises of outcomes. An outcome is a statement that describes the required competency that must be demonstrated by the learner on successful completion of a training intervention.

4. Assessments

In order to assess whether a learner can actually demonstrate the desired outcomes, assessment criteria are included in the unit standard. Each outcome has its own set of assessment criteria.

REMEMBER.....

The assessment criteria describe the evidence that is needed that will show that the learner has demonstrated the outcome correctly.

Kindly refer to the unit standard attached hereto for the assessment criteria.

It is of utmost importance that the learner fully understands the assessment criteria as listed in the unit standard, as it is the only way in which the learner will know what he will be assessed against.

The **final or summative assessment** is the most important aspect of this training program. It is during this process that the learner will be declared competent or not yet competent.

The learner will know exactly how he will be assessed, and when and where he will be assessed. All of these details must be obtained from the training provider where the learner enrolled for his program.

5. Range statements

REMEMBER.....

Also included in the unit standard are the range statements in support of the assessment criteria.

The range statements indicate detailed requirements of the assessment criteria.

6. The learning guide

The learner guide is included in this material under various learning units. The learner guide has been designed in such a manner that the learner is guided in a logical way through the learning material and requirements of the unit standard.

On completion of this skill program, the learner will be assessed against the assessment criteria as stipulated in the unit standard.

Each of the modules consists of learner outcomes to be achieved during training and development interventions, work related experience or at your own time. The learner outcomes will enable you to achieve the required level of confidence and competence in order to undergo the summative (final evaluations) assessment.

The learner needs to assess his own knowledge and skill throughout the training process by completing the learner workbook. With the completion of the workbook you start collecting evidence to proof your competence. The learner workbook will be assessed (FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT)

TAKE NOTE

The learner guide will remain the property of the learner once the LEARNING PROGRAM has been completed.

TAKE NOTE

- The best results will be obtained if you start with Study Unit 1 in the Learner Guide, and work your way through it, study unit by study unit.
- All learning outcomes are vital and must be studied (and exercised for all practical requirements) thoroughly to ensure that enough evidence for all specific outcomes is generated.

7. Learning assumed to be in place

It is assumed that a learner which registers for this program have completed a program in communication at NQF Level 3 or equivalent.

It is imperative to understand that this program are only one of the building blocks to complete Skills program 1. The complete list of unit standards for Skills program appears on the next page.

7.1 Security program matrix
UNIT STANDARDS:

	ID	UNIT STANDARD TITLE	LEVEL	CREDITS
Core	244176	Use security equipment	Level 2	2
Core	114941	Apply knowledge of HIV/AIDS to a specific business sector and a workplace	Level 3	4
Core	244184	Apply legal aspects in a security environment	Level 3	8
Core	244177	Conduct a security patrol in an area of responsibility	Level 3	7
Core	117705	Demonstrate knowledge of the Firearms Control Act 2000 (Act No 60 of 2000) applicable to possessing a firearm	Level 3	3
Core	246694	Explain the requirements for becoming a security service provider	Level 3	4
Core	244182	Give evidence in court	Level 3	4
Core	244179	Handle complaints and problems	Level 3	6
Core	244181	Perform hand over and take over responsibilities	Level 3	2
Core	244189	Conduct access and egress control	Level 4	7
Core	242825	Conduct evacuations and emergency drills	Level 4	4
Core	11505	Identify, handle and defuse security related conflict	Level 4	12
Fundamental	119472	Accommodate audience and context needs in oral/signed communication	Level 3	5
Fundamental	9010	Demonstrate an understanding of the use of different number bases and measurement units and an awareness of error in the context of relevant calculations	Level 3	2
Fundamental	9013	Describe, apply, analyse and calculate shape and motion in 2- and 3-dimensional space in different contexts	Level 3	4
Fundamental	119457	Interpret and use information from texts	Level 3	5
Fundamental	9012	Investigate life and work related problems using data and probabilities	Level 3	5
Fundamental	119467	Use language and communication in occupational learning programmes	Level 3	5
Fundamental	7456	Use mathematics to investigate and monitor the financial aspects of personal, business and national issues	Level 3	5
Fundamental	119465	Write/present/sign texts for a range of communicative contexts	Level 3	5
Elective	117889	Demonstrate an understanding of Victim Empowerment	Level 2	6
Elective	12484	Perform basic fire fighting	Level 2	4
Elective	13912	Apply knowledge of self and team in order to develop a plan to enhance team performance	Level 3	5
Elective	244178	Apply neighbourhood watch principles	Level 3	5
Elective	113852	Apply occupational health, safety and environmental principles	Level 3	10
Elective	243188	Care for a service dog	Level 3	15
Elective	116534	Carry out basic first aid treatment in the workplace	Level 3	2

UNIT STANDARD 119457: INTERPRET AND USE INFORMATION FROM TEXTS

Elective	113909	Coach a team member in order to enhance individual performance in work environment	Level 3	5
Elective	114942	Describe how to manage reactions arising from a traumatic event	Level 3	2
Elective	243190	Handle a trained service dog to deter crime	Level 3	8
Elective	119649	Handle and use a handgun	Level 3	2
Elective	119651	Handle and use a manually operated rifle or carbine	Level 3	2
Elective	119650	Handle and use a self-loading rifle or carbine	Level 3	2
Elective	119652	Handle and use a shotgun	Level 3	2
Elective	114979	Operate a computer workstation in a business environment	Level 3	2
Elective	244335	Conduct security at an event	Level 4	5
Elective	252174	Demonstrate an understanding of security measures within a port security environment	Level 4	4
Elective	246693	Explain the requirements for safeguarding a national key point	Level 4	4
Elective	123515	Handle and use a handgun for business purposes	Level 4	3
Elective	123519	Handle and use a manually operated rifle or carbine for business purposes	Level 4	3
Elective	123511	Handle and use a self loading rifle or carbine for business	Level 4	3
Elective	123514	Handle and use a shotgun for business purposes	Level 4	3
Elective	11985	Inspect, drive and maintain an official vehicle	Level 4	3
Elective	11513	Operate effectively within a specified control room environment	Level 4	15

8. Preparation of summative assessment

After you have worked through the **LEARNER GUIDE** and you are satisfied that all theoretical and practical requirements/ evidence, as stipulated by the UNIT STANDARD, can be met, you need to make your own necessary arrangements with the assessor and/or facilitator. The training establishment will then arrange a suitable date for you to attend your pre-assessment meeting and then arrange for a suitable date to complete the final assessment.

8.1 RPL assessment



The assessment of RPL learners will be conducted in the same way as for those of new learners. The assessment pack is exactly the same and will therefore be used for new learners as well as RPL Learners. It must however be noted that learners who are applying for RPL must provide proof of previous learning and subject related experience prior to the assessment.

This proof or evidence can be in the format of certified copies (certificates) of previous learning programs that have been attended.

All the evidence will be assessed and authenticated before a learner will be allowed to enroll for an RPL program.

9. Roles and responsibilities

9.1 Facilitator/instructor

- Prepare to facilitate.
- Transfer of knowledge and skills

9.2 The role of the assessor

- Plan for the assessment
- Prepare the learner for the assessment

9.3 The role of the Learner

- Prepare for assessment.
- Accept the responsibility of learning.
- Accept the responsibility to produce/deliver evidence.

STUDY UNIT 1

Reading and/or viewing strategies

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Identify unfamiliar words and their correct meaning.
- ♦ Analyse and assess different meanings of ambiguous words.
- ♦ Define the main idea of a text.
- ♦ Define and summarize supporting evidence.
- ♦ Summarize a text.
- ♦ Explained and identify various graphic representation.
- ♦ Identify and explain features of visual texts.

1. Introduction

In order for anyone to interpret and use information from texts (the written word/visual information), it is necessary to be able to read *and* understand what is being read.

Reading consists of various strategies that help us understand the text.

2. Unfamiliar words and their correct meaning

We need to identify unfamiliar words and determine their correct meaning by using the following knowledge:

2.1 Syntax, word-attack skills, analysis skills and contextual clues.



Syntax: Syntax is the grammatical arrangement of words in a sentence.

2.2 Word-attack skills (also known as decoding skills)



Word-attack skills are the ability to convert graphic symbols into intelligible language.

Reading skills come from the following:

- ♦ Seeing language as made up of units of sound and units of meaning
- ♦ Seeing print as letters symbolising sounds, words, and discourse units of language such as sentences, paragraphs, and quotations
- ♦ Seeing relationships of ideas and the ability to infer, evaluate, and conclude (This is both a goal of reading and a skill.)

EXAMPLE:

Here are some examples of word attack skills:

- ◆ Seeing the component parts of words
- ◆ Blending these parts into new words
- ◆ Recognizing syllable patterns
- ◆ Recognizing symbols for consonant sounds
- ◆ Recognizing symbols for vowel sounds
- ◆ Recognizing symbols for tone
- ◆ Recognizing capital letters (upper case) and knowing when to use them.
- ◆ Recognizing punctuation and how it affects reading for meaning and expression
- ◆ Recognizing the use of space to mark word breaks and paragraphs
- ◆ Using the above skills simultaneously with comprehension and critical reading skills

2.3 Analysis skills

The two most important thinking process skills are analysis and evaluation.

DEFINITION

Analysis: to organize and manipulate acquired data so that conclusions may be drawn.

DEFINITION

Evaluation: The process of looking at something and deciding what is better, by how much and why.

Analysis skills are therefore the ability to organise and manipulate acquired data so that conclusions may be drawn, and then to decide which conclusions are better, by how much and why.

2.4 Contextual Clues

DEFINITION

Contextual clues are hints that the author gives to help define a difficult or unusual word.

The clue may appear within the same sentence as the word to which it refers, or it may be in a preceding or subsequent sentence. Because most of your vocabulary is gained through reading, it is important that you be able to recognize and take advantage of context clues.

Types of context clues: There are at least *four kinds* of context clues that are quite common.

♦ **Synonym**

DEFINITION

A synonym, or word with the same meaning, is used in the sentence. My opponent's argument is fallacious, misleading, plain wrong.

♦ **Antonym**

DEFINITION

A word or group of words that has the opposite meaning, reveals the meaning of an unknown term. Although some men are loquacious, others hardly talk at all.

♦ **Explanation**

DEFINITION

The unknown word is explained within the sentence or in a sentence immediately preceding.

The patient is so somnolent that she requires medication to help her stay awake for more than a short time.

EXAMPLE:

Specific examples are used to define the term.

Celestial bodies, such as the sun, moon, and stars, are governed by predictable laws.

In order to be successful with the above skills, the following knowledge is vital:

◆ **Borrowed words**

Borrowed words are English words that have been borrowed from other languages. Examples are:

EXAMPLE:

kindergarten	"child garden", meaning pre-school	German
quartz	"rock"	German
alphabet	"alpha" and "beta"	Greek
rhinoceros	"horned nose"	Greek
spaghetti	"little strings"	Italian
risk	"run into danger"	Italian
bonsai	"planted in a tray"	Japanese
karate	"empty hand"	Japanese
impala		Zulu
mamba		Zulu
dentist	"tooth person"	French
menu	"list"	French

2.5 Complex terms

There are different ways to say the same thing, it can be done in a simple way or in a complex way. Often people tend to use complex terms when wanting to show off, but sometimes it is necessary to use them, as in standard operating procedures

EXAMPLE:

'The interior of the domestic abode was tediously monochromatic', or in simple terms, 'the inside of the house was boring, because it was all the same colour'.

2.6 Acronyms

These are words created by the first letters of longer words. They are used as a shortcut to getting your message across and are usually related to a specific industry, although some are accepted in general conversation.



- ♦ SARS: South African Revenue Services
- ♦ AIDS: Acquired Immune Deficiency Syndrome

2.7 Neologisms

These are newly coined words or phrases, or familiar words used in a new sense.



- ♦ Ambilingual: switch between languages without losing train of thought (from ambidextrous and bilingual)
- ♦ Artlang: artistic language
- ♦ Blurple: blue and purple
- ♦ Floordrobe: the layer of clothing often found coating the floor of a messy person's dwelling
- ♦ Infomania: unquenchable thirst for knowledge
- ♦ Vocabularian: one who makes up new words

2.8 Colloquialisms



A colloquialism is an expression not used in formal speech, or writing. Colloquialisms denote a manner of speaking or writing that is characteristic of familiar "common" conversation; informal colloquialisms can include words (such as "y'all" or "gonna"), phrases (such as "ain't nothin").

Colloquialisms are often used primarily within a limited geographical area. An example is for a soft drink. In the upper midwest (of the United States), it is commonly called "pop", while in other areas its "soda." In the southern United States, it is commonly called "Coke".

2.9 Slang

DEFINITION

Slang is the use of highly informal words and expressions that are not considered standard in the speaker's dialect or language.

Slang is sometimes regional in that it is used only in a particular territory, but slang terms are frequently particular to a certain subculture, such as musicians, and members of minority groups. Nevertheless, usage of slang expressions can spread outside their original arenas to become commonly used, such as "cool" and "jive".

2.10 Jargon

DEFINITION

Jargon is terminology / "technical talk" that relates to a specific activity, profession or group.

Much like slang it develops as a kind of shorthand, to quickly express ideas that are frequently discussed between members of a group. Is the language used by people who work in a particular area or who have a common interest: lawyers, computer programmers, criminals, etc. All have specialized terms and expressions that they use, many of which may not be comprehensible to the outsider.

EXAMPLE:

- ♦ Medical jargon: **Bilateral probital hematoma:** black eye (shiner - slang)
- ♦ Business jargon: **Buy-in:** agreement/consent ;
Facetime: time spent speaking face-to-face (not via the phone or internet)
- ♦ Cell phone jargon: **BTW:** by the way
FAQ: frequently asked questions
MOTD: message of the day
HTH: hope this helps

2.11 Dialect

DEFINITION

A dialect is a variety of a language that is characteristic of a particular group of the language's speakers.

The term is applied most often to regional speech patterns, but a dialect may also be defined by other factors, such as social class.

3. Different options for the meanings of ambiguous words must be tested, and selected meanings corrected in relation to the context.

An ambiguous word is a word that has more than one meaning. Ambiguous writing could consist of ambiguous words or could be sentences that appear to mean one thing, but actually mean something different. This is often achieved by lack of concrete detail. Some writers use this technique to great effect, allowing the reader to interpret their words in varying ways.

EXAMPLE:

"The people were revolting."

Revolting can mean horrible/disgusting or it can mean rebelling against something. If the sentence reads "the people were revolting after cleaning the sewers the whole day", then you know it means disgusting. If the sentence reads "the people were revolting because they could tolerate the corruption of their leaders no longer", then it means they rebelled.

The only way to make sure that you understand what is being said, is to test the meaning in relation to what the rest of the information is saying.

If your understanding of the word or sentence fits in with the rest of the information, you can be sure that you are correct. If not, find another meaning for the word or sentence that will fit in with the rest of the information.

This will prevent you from ending up with the wrong idea, which could lead to confusion and misunderstanding.

4. Main ideas must be separated from supporting evidence, and paraphrased or summarized.

4.1 What is a main idea?



- ♦ The main idea gives readers a clear and specific idea of the topic.
- ♦ The main idea should also include some opinion about the topic.
- ♦ The main idea can be thought of as a one or two sentence summary of the whole writing project.
- ♦ The main idea is usually stated early on.

4.2 What is supporting evidence?



- ♦ Supporting evidence supports or 'colours in' the main idea.
- ♦ Supporting evidence makes the main idea 'digestible', more understandable.

With this knowledge, you should be able to separate the main idea from the supporting evidence.

4.3 What is a summary?



- ♦ A summary is a short version of a longer piece of writing.

- ♦ The summary should contain all the important parts of the original, but expresses them in a shorter space.
- ♦ Summarising is a very useful skill when gathering information.
- ♦ The summary should be written in your own words. It's more useful to re-write the contents, rather than copying out parts of the original.
- ♦ Read the original quickly, and try to understand its main subject.
- ♦ Then you will need to read it again to understand it in more detail.
- ♦ Underline or make a note of the main points. Use a highlighter if this helps. Look up any words or ideas you don't know. You need to understand the sentences and how they relate to each other.
- ♦ Work through the writing to spot the main sections or arguments. These might be shown as paragraphs.

REMEMBER.....

Remember that the purpose of a paragraph is that it deals with just one issue or topic. Draw up a list of the topics - or make a diagram. A simple picture of boxes or a spider diagram can often be helpful.

- ♦ Write a one or two-sentence version of each section. Just express the main point. Leave out any examples.
- ♦ Write a sentence which states the main idea of the original writing.
- ♦ Use this as the starting point. Then write a paragraph which combines all the points you have made.
- ♦ The final summary should capture the main point of the original.

REMEMBER.....

- ♦ Remember that it should be in your own words. You re-create the meaning of the original in a way which makes sense for you.

EXAMPLE:

Original:

At a typical football match we are likely to see players committing deliberate fouls, often behind the referee's back. They might try to take a throw-in or a free kick from an incorrect but more advantageous position in defiance of the clearly stated rules of the game. They sometimes challenge the rulings of the referee or linesmen in an offensive way, which often deserves punishment or even sending off. No wonder this leads spectators to fight amongst themselves, damage stadiums, or take the law into their own hands by invading the pitch in the hope of affecting the outcome of the match. [100 words]

Summary

Unsporting behaviour by footballers may cause hooliganism among spectators. [9 words]

4.4 What is paraphrase?



- ♦ Paraphrase is the restatement of a text or passage in different words, often to clarify meaning.
- ♦ A paraphrase is typically more detailed than a summary.

The purpose of separating the main idea from the supporting evidence and then summarising/paraphrasing it, is to ensure that you are clear about the message/information the writer is wanting to convey to you.

5. The purpose of visual and/or graphic representations in texts are recognized and explained.

In order to recognize and understand the purpose of visual and/or graphic representations in texts, it is necessary to look beyond what you see initially. A skill that helps you do this is called critical reading.

What is critical reading ?

To non -critical readers, texts provide facts. To the critical reader, any single text provides but one portrayal of the facts, one individual's "take" on the subject matter. Critical readers thus recognize not only what a text says, but also how that text portrays the subject matter. They recognize the various ways in which each and every text is the unique creation of a unique author.

To read critically is to make judgments about how a text is argued. This is a highly reflective skill requiring you to "stand back" and gain some distance from the text you are reading. (You might have to read a text through once to get a basic grasp of content before you launch into an intensive critical reading.)

A non-critical reader might read a history book to learn the facts of the situation or to discover an accepted interpretation of those events. A critical reader might read the same work to appreciate how a particular perspective on the events and a particular selection of facts can lead to particular understanding.

Non-critical reading is satisfied with recognizing what a text says and restating the key remarks.

Critical reading goes two steps further. Having recognized what a text says , it reflects on what the text does by making such remarks,

"Is it offering examples?" "Arguing?" "Appealing for sympathy?" "Making a contrast to clarify a point?" Finally, critical readers then infer what the text, as a whole, means , based on the earlier analysis.

**Goals of Critical Reading:**

- ♦ to recognize an author's purpose
- ♦ to understand tone and persuasive elements
- ♦ to recognize bias

Using the critical reading skill discussed above will enable you to recognize the purpose of the author's complete text.

6. Features of visual texts are explained in relation to the way they impact on meaning.

A visual or graphic text/aid is often used when it is too difficult to describe something in words.

A visual aid might be a symbol, a graph, a chart, a table, a painting, a photograph, a cartoon, a three-dimensional model, or other representation. Informational graphics (infographics) convey important information in a clear, precise, and efficient manner.

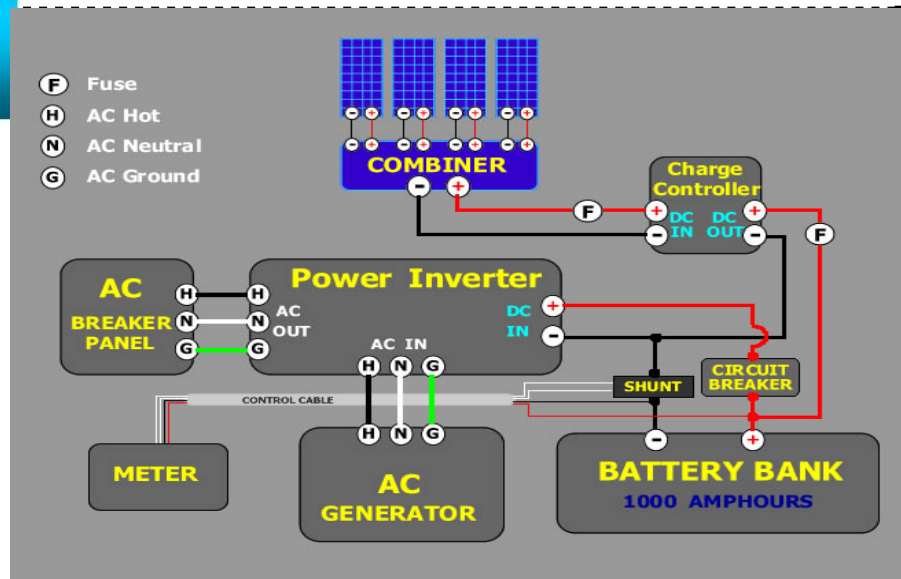
They visually convey key data. Diagrams, pictures, charts, graphs, and maps are intended to communicate vital information. Some common visual and graphic aids are shown in the following chart.

6.1 Common Visual and Graphic Aids

Type	Purpose
Diagram (e.g., Venn, tree, labeled, scale, cutaway, cross-section)	To show the parts or workings of something
Other illustrations (e.g., painting, collage, drawing, poster, photograph)	To illustrate an idea
Chart (e.g., flow chart, table, matrix, timeline)	To present a set of facts or ideas in an organized way
Graph (e.g., bar, line, circle or pie, pictograph)	To show how certain facts are related
Map (e.g., bird's eye-view, scale map or plan, typographic, road or street)	To show spatial relationships, location, distance, routes, and pathways
Three-dimensional (e.g., diorama, tableau, dance, mime, role play)	To portray an idea

EXAMPLE:

♦ Diagram



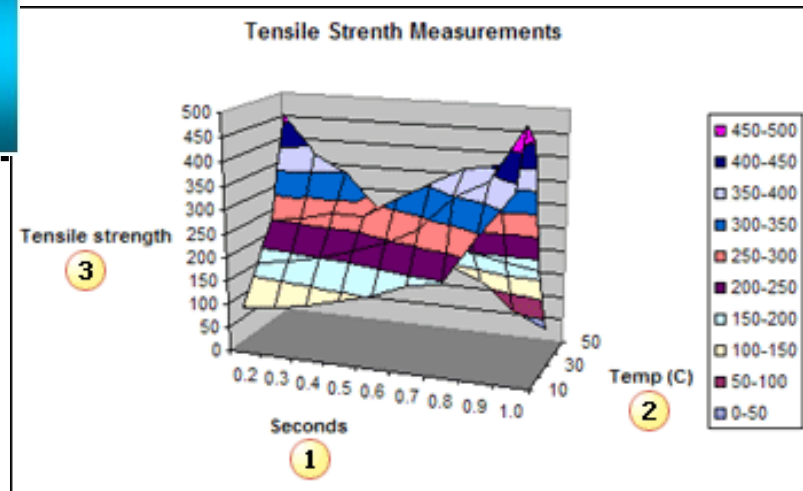
EXAMPLE:

♦ Other illustrations - drawing



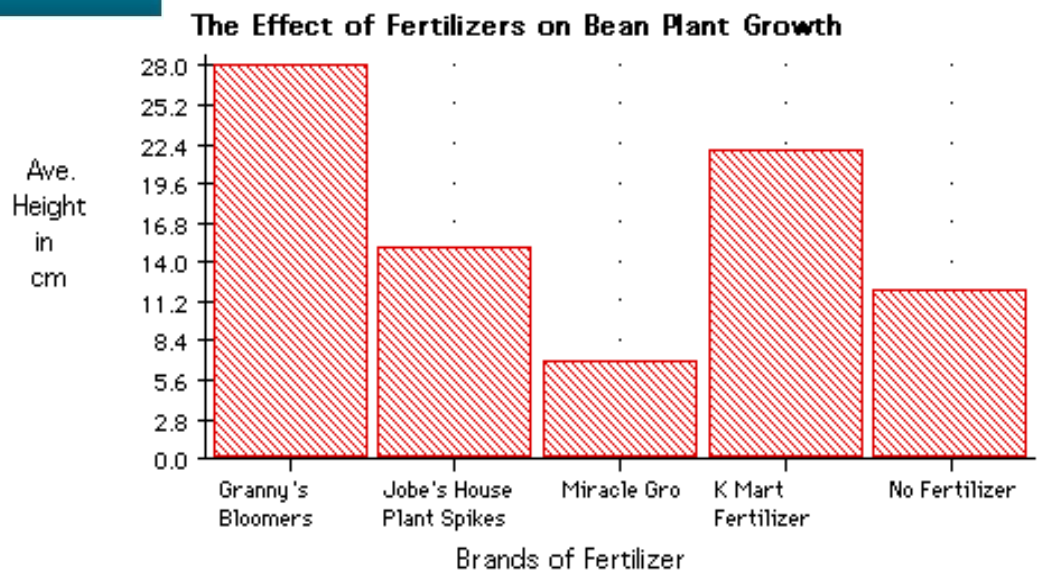
EXAMPLE:

♦ Chart - surface chart



EXAMPLE:

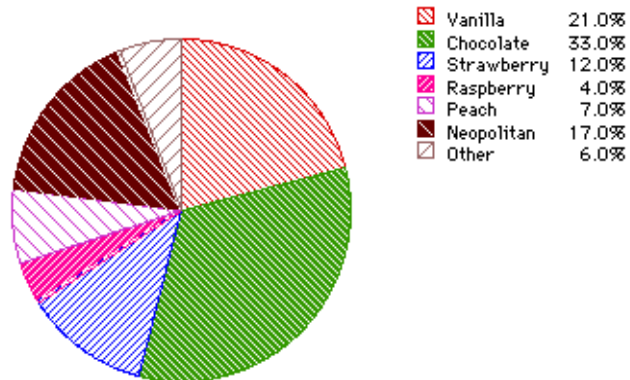
♦ Graphs: bar graph



EXAMPLE:

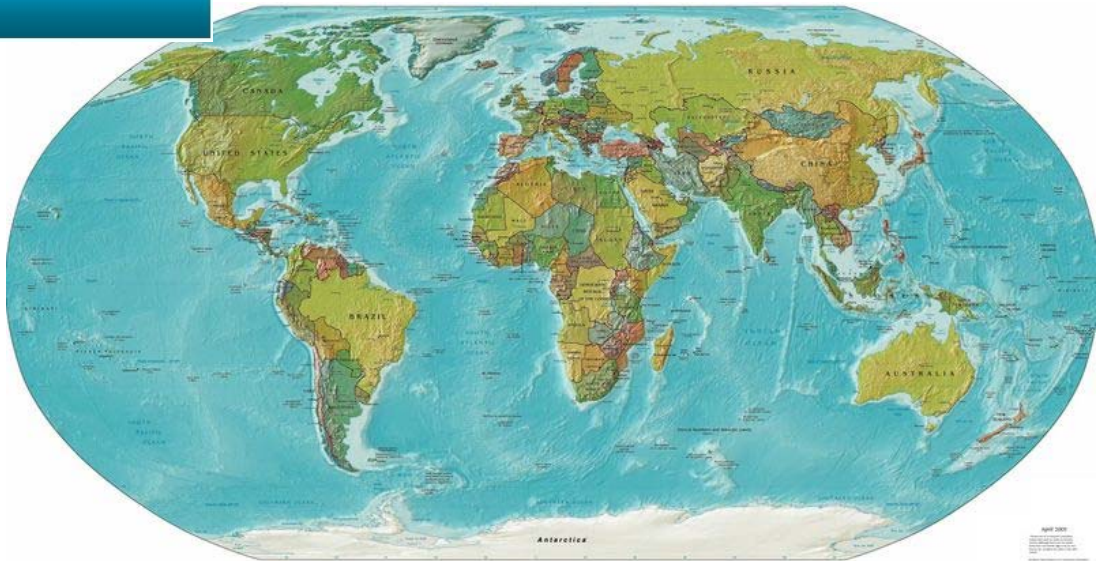
Graphs: pie graph

Twin Groves Ice Cream Survey



EXAMPLE:

♦ **Maps: world map (land and political)**



EXAMPLE:♦ Three-dimensional

These visual and graphic aids are three-dimensional, which means that they are actual examples of what they are explaining, e.g. - a role play between learners in the class portraying a customer complaint, or a diorama (a miniature three-dimensional scene in which models of figures are seen against a background).

EXAMPLE:♦ diorama

To be effective, visual and graphic aids should be:

- ♦ visible
- ♦ neat
- ♦ accurate
- ♦ instantly understandable.

You might begin exploring the basic principles behind effective representations that use visual and graphic aids. Consider the following questions:

- ♦ What sequence or layout will help the audience understand the representation?
- ♦ What points need special emphasis?
- ♦ What gestures, photographs, and other visual cues will guide the audience?
- ♦ What graphic aids would best complement these visuals?

Communication through visual and graphic aids is enhanced when you understand the elements and principles of visual design. You should consider employing the principles of design, including attending to focal point, colour, size, perspective, balance and movement, to make the message easy to grasp. Posters, book jackets, and print advertisements could be used to further explore the principles of design and layout.

Work with words, symbols, sounds, colours, and sequence or placement to communicate clearly and concisely.

Visual design helps communication:

- ♦ **Composition:** putting all the bits together; working out how the pieces are placed in relationship to each other and to the viewer.



- ♦ who or what holds the centre of attention in the picture?
- ♦ how does the position help make this the centre of attention?
- ♦ how does the background contribute to the ideas you get?
- ♦ how are people placed in relationship to each other and to objects in the photo/picture? what is suggested by the placements? - respect? - affection? - conflict? - unity?

- ♦ **Camera angle:** high angle which can show dominance, low angle which can show submission, or eye level.
- ♦ **Framing/Proximity:** close up shot (head and shoulders) mid or medium shot (upper part of a person's body) long distance shot (full person showing long distance or depth)
- ♦ **Lighting:** darkness used to indicate gloom; shadows are often sinister, while lightness can show joy or happiness
- ♦ **Colour:** red with anger/red as danger
- ♦ **Foregrounding:** employing unusual forms of language - breaks up the reader's routine behavior: commonplace views and perspectives are replaced by new and surprising insights and sensations, something may be given special prominence.
- ♦ **Font type, font size, headlines, captions and subtitles:** these all need to be used in such a way that they draw the viewer's attention to what needs to be focused on.

Taking all the abovementioned features of visual texts into account will help you understand how they impact on the total meaning of the author's text.

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

STUDY UNIT 2

Use a range of strategies

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Identify the source of text and assess it for reliability and possible biased meaning.
- ♦ Explore attitudes, beliefs and intention.
- ♦ Explain and apply techniques used in terms of purpose and audience.
- ♦ Explain and identify selection of information.

1. Introduction

Before we look at this learning unit, it is important to understand what is meant by implicit messages.



DEFINITION

Implicit means *implied* or *indirect*. The implicit message is the connection made between the information in the text and the information in the reader's head.

It is the drawn inferences about the author's meaning. It is possible for a reader to understand the explicit information (the actual written text) contained in a passage of text, but to fail to grasp the implicit message contained "between the lines." Similarly, it is possible for a reader to appreciate the implicit message contained in the text, but to fail to elaborate on that message, failing to connect it to other text or background knowledge.

2. The source of the text must be identified in terms of reliability and possible bias.

In order for a reader to extract the correct implicit messages contained within a text, it is vital to know that the author/writer is reliable and is not biased. Unreliable information can lead the reader in a wrong direction, causing incorrect perceptions or understanding to be formed.

A biased author/writer will lead the reader to extract a subjective implicit message, which is not necessarily the "truth", or "reality".

It is of great importance that the reader determine the reliability and possible bias of the author/writer before reading the text, if there is any doubt about this. This will usually occur with controversial matters.

3. Attitudes, beliefs and intentions must be explored in order to determine the point of view expressed either directly or indirectly.



IMPORTANT

Attitudes, beliefs and intentions play a very important part in the message that an author/writer conveys in a text.

Let us look at the meaning of these three words:

- ♦ **Attitudes:** refers to the feelings and emotions a person has toward something. These feelings and emotions could be positive or negative.

- ♦ **Beliefs:** indicates a person's subjective attitude toward something. It is possible to have various beliefs about the same thing.



Someone may believe "This book is interesting", but they may or may not believe "This book has an attractive cover".

- ♦ **Intentions:** Indicates a person's subjective probability that he/she will perform a particular behaviour toward something.

We can see that as a result of an author/writer's attitudes, beliefs and intentions, he/she has great control over the message that is conveyed in a text. If he/she has a positive attitude about something and believes that it is the correct thing to do, the reader will receive a positive message from the text, and will subsequently be affected in a positive way.

Once again, when difficult or controversial matters are addressed, it would be wise to look into the attitudes, beliefs and intentions of the author/writer, before a conclusion or decision is formulated.

4. Techniques used in terms of purpose and audience are explored and explained.

The way a text is written depends on the purpose thereof, as well as the readers audience) it is aimed at.

The length of a sentence depends on what has to be said. A long sentence will be used for an explanation, but an instruction will be written in a short sentence.

Punctuation should be used appropriately.



An exclamation mark after something exciting, not something serious.

Choice of words should be appropriate and display sensitivity towards the reader.

Figurative language should be used correctly



Technical terms should not be used when the readers are not all familiar with those terms.

Visuals should be relevant to the text and be something the readers can identify with.

5. Identify and explain how selection or omission of information can promote or support a particular line of thought/cause.

The selection, but more so the omission of information, especially vital information, can change a particular line of thought/cause in a text dramatically. This can have far-reaching consequences on the reader - not only how he/she understands the text, but also how he/she uses the information.

Should a text contain incomplete instructions, it is rather certain that the result of the instructions will be unsatisfactory/incorrect.

EXAMPLE:

Should the instructions omit to mention that a combination lock needs to be turned clockwise and anti-clockwise alternately between digits, the lock will not release after all the digits have been entered.

Similarly, should certain information be selected, it could promote or support a particular line of thought.

EXAMPLE:

Someone can cause trouble between a couple by mentioning to one that the other was seen in the company of an immoral person. This could cause that person to become suspicious of their (innocent?) partner, often with disastrous consequences.

When words are being used to manipulate you, you will only be told half the story - the good half, what the manipulator decides you need to know.

Look at the example in the following advertisement:

EXAMPLE:

Yes, you will lose 20 kilos with Burn It Off! - All you need to do is take 2 tablets three times a day! The small print that few read, adds: - but only if you also eat a low calorie, no fat diet and exercise for 30 minutes, five times a week. If you did that you would lose the weight anyway - without the tablets!

As you have seen in the above examples, an author/writer can exercise control over the reader by selection or omission of information. How can you avoid being manipulated like this?

It is not always possible to identify the selection or omission of information, especially if it is new information to you, unless you have access to other sources of the same information.

[illegible]

STUDY UNIT 3

Respond to selected texts

LEARNING OUTCOMES

On completion of this study unit the student will....



- ♦ Act upon instructions and requests.
- ♦ Use text in the correct format and for the appropriate target group.
- ♦ Read text for meaning.
- ♦ Use the correct language structures and features when interpreting text.

1. Introduction

Texts are written for specific reasons. They could contain information needed to do something; instructions for specific tasks; requests for services; etc. It is therefore vital that the reader's response is appropriate to the context.

2. Instructions and requests are acted upon.

When a reader reads a text containing instructions and/or requests, there are three very important factors that need to be considered.

The first is that the instruction/request needs to be understood/ interpreted correctly. In order to do this, the instruction/request needs to be read in context. It is also helpful to be familiar with the matter at hand.

The second factor is that the instruction/request needs to be acted upon, i.e. you have to DO what is expected of you. It is of no use to know what has to be done, but you fail to execute it.

Thirdly, it is important that you only do what is instructed or requested. Follow the instruction or request carefully - don't do what you THINK has to be done.

3. Text-type, format and register used are on the appropriate level of formality.

Once you have decided on the appropriate response to the context, it is important to convey it in an appropriate manner.

The level of seniority of the recipient or the importance of the matter, will determine the register, format and text-type of the response.



A response to your manager will not be as informal (and maybe as untidy!) as a response to your peer. It will have to be neat, in the correct format and written with the necessary level of formality, using the correct choice of words.

Similarly, your response to a quick, informal request from a co-worker will be far more relaxed, with less attention paid to text-type and format. You will also be more likely to use slang.

4. Comprehension Skills.**DEFINITION**

Comprehension is the decoding and understanding of spoken, written and visual texts.

TAKE NOTE

Comprehension skills are not only for the classroom - they are life skills that need to be developed. WHY? You first learn to read; later you read to learn.

5. Guidelines to assist you in reading for meaning:**5.1 Read through the passage quickly.**

- ♦ get an overview or a general picture of the passage
- ♦ try to visualize what you are reading. (helps you to focus and read for meaning)

5.2 Take note.

- ♦ the title may offer a clue to the contents and the intention of the passage.
- ♦ the author may help you to identify the era (period of time), style and often the subject.
- ♦ the introduction often creates the atmosphere and provides the setting for what is to follow.
- ♦ the conclusion usually ties up the intention of the author.

5.3 Ask these questions.

- ♦ who is the writer? who are the characters?
- ♦ what is the main idea of the passage?
- ♦ where does it take place? (setting)
- ♦ when does it take place? (time, date, era)
- ♦ why has this passage been written? (what is the writer's intention?)
- ♦ how does the writer express himself? (what language devices are used?)

5.4 Read through the comprehension questions.

- ♦ when you do this, bear the passage in mind
- ♦ this will give you clues leading to the answers in the passage

5.5 Read the passage again.

- ♦ this time you should be aware of what has been asked
- ♦ highlight the main idea in each paragraph (each paragraph presents a new idea)
- ♦ the first sentence is often the key sentence
- ♦ words and ideas that were at first confusing or difficult, may now become clearer in context.
- ♦ the more familiar you are with the passage, the easier it should become to interpret and understand what you are reading.

6. Answering techniques

It is important to interpret and follow the instructions exactly as they are given - don't do what you think should be done!

- ♦ does the answer need a full sentence, a word or a phrase?
- ♦ avoid starting sentences with conjunctions such as because, and, but and so.
- ♦ the mark allocation is usually an indication of the number of points needed.
- ♦ your numbering must correspond to the numbering of the questions (if they number it a. you must not number it 1.)
- ♦ if you are asked to describe in three sentences what the character looks like, do not give two or four sentences.
- ♦ do not give one word answers if you are asked for sentences.
- ♦ each answer must be written on a new line.
- ♦ when quoting from the text, enclose the quote with single inverted commas.
- ♦ when asked to describe the tone of any text, use one adjective.
- ♦ edit your work to check that you have answered correctly, spelling and language errors result in an unnecessary loss of marks.
- ♦ write clearly and neatly to avoid possible discrepancies.
- ♦ do not copy directly from the text, but refer to it in order to avoid careless factual or spelling mistakes.
- ♦ if you are asked to supply a synonym or an antonym, replace it with the same part of speech e.g. a noun with a noun, an adverb with an adverb (then replace the original word in the passage with your synonym and see if it is appropriate)

7. Language structures and features

Language structures and features are powerful tools in the hands of the competent author/writer. They allow him/her to influence a reader unwittingly.

Should the writer use *humour* to convey a message, the reader will engage a positive, relaxed attitude, which will be conducive to the acceptance of the message. Alternatively, should the reader detect *sarcasm*, he/she could engage a negative attitude, which could have a snowball effect and might result in trouble.

If the writer uses *bias*, be it cultural, religious, racist, sexist, or any other, it could have a negative influence on some readers, but it could also influence other indecisive readers to make up their mind as to how they perceive certain matters/issues.

Unknowingly, *repetition* will make the reader remember certain things, just as *generalizations* will take the focus off other matters that the writer does not want emphasized.

You have now looked at various strategies, techniques and responses, which should assist you to interpret and use information from texts successfully, in order to achieve the required outcome.

[illegible]

WORDS/ACRONYMS	EXPLANATION OF ACRONYMS
ASSESSMENT	“A structured process of gathering evidence and making judgments about an individual’s performance in relation to registered national standards and qualifications”
ASSESSMENT CRITERIA	It describe the evidence that is needed to show that the learner has demonstrated the outcome correctly. A list of evidence to be supplied by the candidate as proof of his / her ability to integrate all of the competencies listed earlier in the standard.
COMPETENCE	Competence is the ability to do certain things in a range of different environments with knowledge and understanding about what is being done and the effect this has on others. It includes <u>Knowledge, skills, attitudes, values and ethics.</u>
CREDIT	Each unit standard is worth a number of credits which gives an indication of the size and scope of the unit standard, the standard is worth. (1 credit = 10 notional hours of learning)
CRITICAL CROSSFIELD OUTCOMES	critical cross field outcomes is to direct educational activities towards development of the learners within a social and economic environment.
EMBEDDED KNOWLEDGE	Body of theory essential for understanding and applying the standard. Principles, methods and techniques that would underpin good practice of this unit standard.
EVIDENCE	Evidence is a set of information or observations that provides proof of the learner’s competence.
FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT	Aims to assist the learner to identify any knowledge/skills gaps when demonstrating his/her current competence. Diagnostic assessment supports learning and progress of the learner.
INTEGRATED ASSESSMENT	Integrated assessment refers to: • assessing a number of outcomes together • assessing a number of assessment criteria together • assessing a number of unit standards together • using a combination of assessment methods and instruments for an outcome/s • collecting naturally occurring evidence in the workplace • Acquiring evidence from other sources such as supervisor’s reports, testimonials, portfolio of work previously done, logbooks, journals etc.
LEARNING ASSUMED TO BE IN PLACE	Building blocks (knowledge, skill and understanding) assumed to be in place
LEARNING PROGRAM	A “learning program is a set of learning activities in which the learner will be involved in working towards the achievement of one or more outcomes.
LEVEL	Each unit standard is registered on the NQF at a particular level based on the complexity of the outcomes and stringency of the standards.
NQF	National Qualifications Framework
RANGE STATEMENTS	The range statements indicate detailed requirements of the assessment criteria.

RE-ASSESSMENT	• The same method and instrument may be used, but, the task and materials should be different • The task and materials should, however, be of the same complexity and level as the previous ones. • In case the methods and instruments are changed it must be ensured that they are appropriate for the outcomes specified.
RPL ASSESSMENT	RPL is a way of recognizing what individuals already know and can do. The basic premise underlying it is that people, especially mature adults, learn many things inside and outside the formal structures of education and training and that irrespective of where, how and when learning was acquired, subject to assessment, it can be worthy of recognition and credit.
RPL	Recognition of prior learning
SASSETA	Safety & security sector education and training authority.
SAQA	SOUTH AFRICAN QUALIFICATION AUTHORITY
SPECIFIC OUTCOMES	An outcome is a statement that describes the required competency that must be demonstrated by the learner on successful completion of a training intervention. Key performance areas in the standard are given, the focus is <i>not</i> only on current competence, but also on future competence in this standard.
SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT	Assessment used to record the level of competence achieved by a learner over a period of time, e.g. at the end of a program, term or year.
QUALIFICATIONS	Represent a planned combination of learning outcomes which has a defined purpose and intended to provide learners with applied competence and a basis for further learning
UNIT STANDARDS	the “building blocks” of qualifications. All qualifications are plotted on the National Qualifications Framework (NQF). “A statement of the outcomes that the learner must achieve to earn credit. Standards are nationally agreed and internationally comparable.”

Comprehension skills taken from 'English Handbook and Study Guide' - Beryl Lutrin and Marcelle Pincus (Berlut Books CC)

Interpret and use information from texts

SAQA US ID	UNIT STANDARD TITLE		
119457	Interpret and use information from texts		
ORIGINATOR		REGISTERING PROVIDER	
SGB GET/FET Language and Communication			
FIELD		SUBFIELD	
Field 04 - Communication Studies and Language		Language	
ABET BAND	UNIT STANDARD TYPE	NQF LEVEL	CREDITS
Undefined	Regular-Fundamental	Level 3	5
REGISTRATION STATUS	REGISTRATION START DATE	REGISTRATION END DATE	SAQA DECISION NUMBER
Registered	2006-02-09	2009-02-09	SAQA 0264/06
LAST DATE FOR ENROLMENT		LAST DATE FOR ACHIEVEMENT	
2010-02-09		2013-02-09	

This unit standard replaces:

US ID	Unit Standard Title	NQF Level	Credits	Replacement Status
8969	Interpret and use information from texts	Level 3	5	Complete

PURPOSE OF THE UNIT STANDARD

Learners at this level read and view a range of texts. People credited with this unit standard are able to read and view a variety of text types with understanding and to justify their views and responses by reference to detailed evidence from texts. They are also able to evaluate the effectiveness of different texts for different audiences and purposes by using a set of criteria for analysis.

Learners credited with this unit standard are able to:

- Use a range of reading and viewing strategies to understand the literal meaning of specific texts
- Use strategies for extracting implicit messages in texts
- Respond to selected texts in a manner appropriate to the context
- Explore and explain how language structures and features may influence a reader/viewer

LEARNING ASSUMED TO BE IN PLACE AND RECOGNITION OF PRIOR LEARNING

The credit calculation is based on the assumption that learners are already competent in terms of the following outcomes or areas of learning when starting to learn towards this unit standard: Level 2 unit standards entitled Access and use information from texts.

UNIT STANDARD RANGE

A variety of written and/or signed/visual texts used in socio-cultural, learning and workplace contexts.

Specific range statements are provided in the body of the unit standard where they apply to particular specific outcomes or assessment criteria.

Specific Outcomes and Assessment Criteria:

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 1

Use a range of reading and/or viewing strategies to understand the literal meaning of specific texts.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1

Unfamiliar words/signs are identified. Their meanings are correctly determined by using knowledge of syntax, word-attack skills/sign parameter/analysis skills, and contextual clues.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Borrowed words/signs, complex terms, acronyms, neologisms, colloquialisms, slang, jargon, dialect.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Different options for the meanings of ambiguous words are tested, and selected meanings are correct in relation to the context.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

Main ideas are separated from supporting evidence and paraphrased or summarised.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 4

The purpose of visual and/or graphic representations in texts are recognised and explained.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 5

Features of visual texts are explained in relation to the way they impact on meaning.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Composition, layout, light, foregrounding, backgrounding, perspective, camera angle, frame, sequence, use of colour/black and white, font type, font size, headlines, captions, subtitles.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 2

Use strategies for extracting implicit messages in texts.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1

Source of text is identified and discussed in terms of reliability and possible bias.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Attitudes, beliefs and intentions are explored in order to determine the point of view expressed either directly or indirectly.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 3

Techniques are explored and explained in terms of purpose and audience.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Length of sentence, punctuation/non-manual features (NMFs), diction/choice of words, use of figurative language/jargon/technical terms/slang/dialect/irony/humour/satire/sarcasm/legalisms, choice of visuals, choice of camera angle, type of shot, cinematographic techniques.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 4

Promotion of, or support for, a particular line of thought/cause is identified and explained with reference to selection or omission of materials.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 3

Respond to selected texts in a manner appropriate to the context.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1**

Instructions and requests are acted upon.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION 2

Text-type, format and register used are on the appropriate level of formality.

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 4

Explore and explain how language structures and features may influence a reader/viewer.

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA**ASSESSMENT CRITERION 1**

The choice of words/signs, language usage, symbols, pictures and tone/sign size and pace is described in terms of how a point of view is shaped or supported.

ASSESSMENT CRITERION RANGE

Bias (cultural, religious or peer preferences, misrepresentation, discrimination, racist, sexist, ageist); humour; irony; sarcasm, use of omission and silence, figurative expressions, repetition; hyperbole; generalisations; stereotyping; pictures and captions; typography and grammar.

UNIT STANDARD ACCREDITATION AND MODERATION OPTIONS

Accreditation Options:

- Providers of learning towards this unit standard will need to meet the accreditation requirements of the relevant ETQA.

Moderation Option:

- The moderation requirements of the relevant ETQA must be met in order to award credit to learners for this unit standard.

UNIT STANDARD ESSENTIAL EMBEDDED KNOWLEDGE

The essential embedded knowledge will be assessed through assessment of the specific outcomes in terms of the stipulated assessment criteria.

Learners can understand and explain that languages have certain features and conventions, which can be manipulated. Learners can apply this knowledge and adapt language to suit different contexts, audiences and purposes. Knowledge of formats, conventions, protocols and contexts is acquired through activities used to attain this unit standard.

Learners are unlikely to achieve all the specific outcomes, to the standards described in the assessment criteria, without knowledge of the listed embedded knowledge. This means that for the most part, the possession or lack of the knowledge can be directly inferred from the quality of the learner's performance. Where direct assessment of knowledge is required, assessment criteria have been included in the body of the unit standard.

UNIT STANDARD DEVELOPMENTAL OUTCOME

N/A

UNIT STANDARD LINKAGES

N/A

Critical Cross-field Outcomes (CCFO):**UNIT STANDARD CCFO IDENTIFYING**

Identify and solve problems: using context to decode and make meaning individually and in groups in oral, reading, signed and written activities.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO WORKING

Work effectively with others and in teams: using interactive speech/signing in activities, discussion and research projects.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO ORGANISING

Organise and manage oneself and one`s activities responsibly and effectively through using language.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO COLLECTING

Collect, analyse, organise and critically evaluate information: fundamental to the process of growing language capability across language applications and fields of study.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO COMMUNICATING

Communicate effectively using visual, mathematical and/or language skills: in formal and informal communications.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO SCIENCE

Use science and technology effectively and critically: using technology to access and present texts and exploring the ethics of science and technology through studying texts from and about these fields.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO DEMONSTRATING

Understand the world as a set of inter-related parts of a system: through using language to explore and express links, and exploring a global range of contexts and texts.

UNIT STANDARD CCFO CONTRIBUTING

Contribute to the full development of oneself: by engaging with texts that stimulate awareness and development of life skills and the learning process.